Dengue

Symptoms of Dengue and Testing

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For Everyone

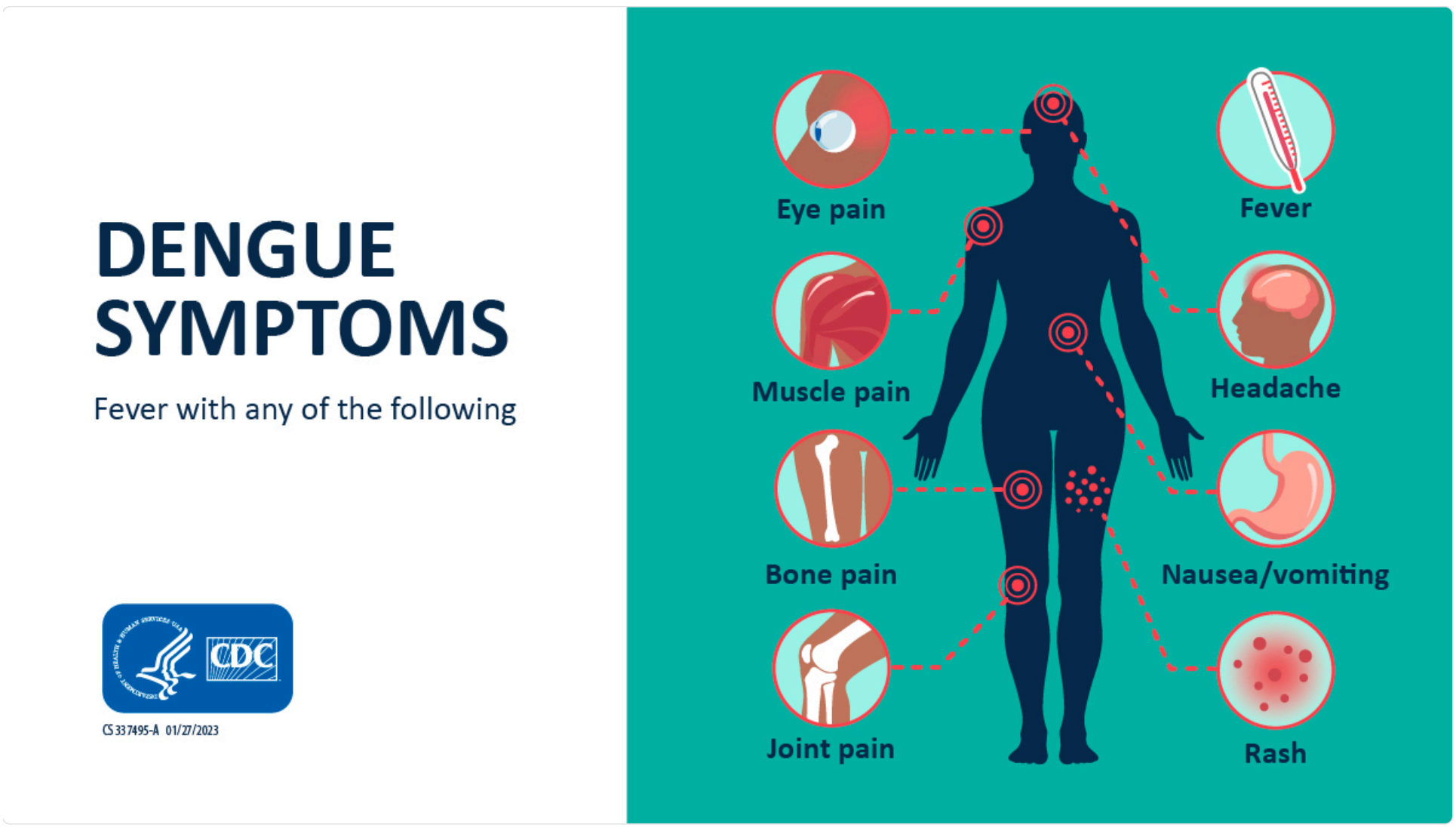
KEY POINTS

- 1 in 4: About one in four people infected with dengue will get sick.
- For people who get sick with dengue, symptoms can be mild or severe.
- Severe dengue can be life-threatening within a few hours and often requires care at a hospital.

Symptoms

The most common symptom of dengue is **fever** with any of the following:

- Aches and pains (eye pain, typically behind the eyes, muscle, joint, or bone pain)
- Nausea, vomiting
- Rash
- Any warning sign



Common symptoms of dengue.

Dengue symptoms
Fever with any of the following
- Eye pain
- Muscle pain
- Bone pain
- Joint pain
- Headache
- Nausea/vomiting
- Rash
CDC logo

- Mild symptoms of dengue can be confused with other illnesses that cause fever.
- Symptoms of dengue typically last 2–7 days.
- Most people will recover after about a week.

When to seek emergency help

Symptoms of dengue can become severe within a few hours. **Severe dengue is a medical emergency.**

About 1 in 20 people who get sick with dengue will develop severe dengue. Severe dengue can result in shock, internal bleeding, and death.

Warning signs are symptoms that indicate a person may be at higher risk for developing severe dengue. Immediately go to a local clinic or emergency room if you or a family member has any of the following warning signs:

- Belly pain or tenderness
- Vomiting (at least 3 times in 24 hours)
- Bleeding from the nose or gums
- Vomiting blood, or blood in the stool
- Feeling extremely tired or restless

Warning signs of severe dengue include bleeding, vomiting, and belly pain.

Watch for **warning signs** of severe dengue after your fever has gone away.

- Bleeding from the nose or gums
- Belly pain, tenderness
- Vomiting (at least 3 times in 24 hours)
- Vomiting blood
- Blood in the stool
- Feeling tired, restless, or irritable

Severe dengue is a medical emergency, and it requires immediate medical care.

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Warning Signs

Watch for warning signs. Warning signs usually begin in the 24–48 hours after fever has gone away.

Testing

- See your healthcare provider if you have symptoms of dengue and live in or have recently traveled to an area with risk of dengue.
- A blood test is the only way to confirm the diagnosis.

  - Laboratory confirmation is not required to manage illness from dengue, and your healthcare provider might provide care based on your signs and symptoms.
- Your healthcare provider may order blood tests to look for dengue or other similar viruses like Zika or chikungunya.

SOURCES

CONTENT SOURCE:
National Center for Emerging and Zoonotic Infectious Diseases (NCEZID)